MiD Marketers in Demand

Washington Speakers Bureau

MARKETING ROADMAP

December 16, 2025

Agenda

- Overview
  - Target Market
  - Brand Positioning & Messaging
  - Products & Solutions
  - Competition
- Roadmap
  - Goals
  - Quarterly Initiatives
  - Plan

Overview

In this initial section, we lay the groundwork for a successful partnership, setting the stage for a marketing roadmap that is both dynamic and results-driven.

We outline the critical components that will shape our journey towards achieving your business objectives.

Here are the core components:

- **Delivering Results through a Six-Phase Process:** At the heart of our roadmap is a meticulously crafted six-phase process that Marketers in Demand utilizes to guarantee tangible results. This process, honed through years of experience, serves as a roadmap, guiding us through the various stages of market analysis, roadmap formulation, and execution. It is a blueprint that ensures every step we undertake is grounded in data and aligned with your overarching business goals.

- **Balancing Long-Term and Short-Term Objectives:** Crafting a roadmap that focuses on both long-term and short-term objectives is a constant balancing act. And that's why we take deliberate steps to monitor short-term success while building with a big picture in mind. With a series of goals, structured meetings, and real-time reporting and analytics, your team has the unique opportunity to deliver in the short and long term.

- **Your Marketing "Machine":** Central to our approach is the marketing "machine" - a dedicated team designed to not only provide strategic direction, but deliver on the plan as well. The team includes three primary roles: 1) Strategists, 2) Specialists, and 3) Production.

With these key ingredients, we plan to work alongside your company to deliver on the long-term/annual goals while delivering on specific priorities for the quarter.

How do we deliver results?

Quarterly

Monthly

1 Research

- Quantitative and qualitative research (brand, content and website assessment)
- Channel analysis (paid, SEO, social)
- Tech stack analysis

2 Alignment

- Discussions around desired goals and business outcomes
- Success metric definition
- Insights from research and existing benchmarks
- Pinpoint priorities

3 Roadmap

- Document current marketing strategy
- Competition
- Performance reporting
- Develop goals
- Establish quarterly initiatives
- Confirm budget

4 Foundation

- Plans for designated channels
- Updates to brand, web, and content plans
- Performance reporting enhancements

5 Execution

- Set up, produce, launch and manage channels
- Produce assets to support owned experiences and campaigns
- Real-time view into progress

6 Analysis

- Review results and compare to goals
- Discuss results in Board & Analytics meetings
- Determine next steps for growth

Marketing research

- **Multi-Model Research Approach:** Utilized multiple Large Language Models (LLMs) for deep, comprehensive industry insights, forecasts, and strategic recommendations.
- **Extensive Data Scraping:** Analyzed competitors' websites, organic search rankings, domain authority, and paid media ads from Google, LinkedIn, and YouTube. Used n8n to automate the data extraction process and consolidate information for the research report.
- **Customer Insights Development:** Identified key customer behaviors, decision-making criteria, pain points, and price sensitivity to inform targeted marketing strategies. Key activities included analyzing industry publications and major industry websites.
- **Actionable Strategic Insights:** Conducted qualitative analysis and evaluated your organization against the competition.

Access Research

Target market

In the initial phase of the strategic process, we zero in on the cornerstone of any successful marketing roadmap: the target market.

This section is dedicated to dissecting and understanding the profile of your ideal customer. It's a deep dive into the psyche, behaviors, and preferences of the individuals or businesses that constitute your potential customers.

Here, we unravel the layers that define your audience, setting the stage for a marketing roadmap that resonates with the exact people you want to attract.

The components of this section are as follows:

- **Understanding the Customers:** We need to understand who we want to connect with before we craft any message or launch a campaign. One of the key building blocks of understanding your target market is pinpointing the types of accounts/people that make the most sense. In this section of the roadmap, we identify the ideal types of customers you want to attract. We pinpoint specific demographics and other key criteria to help us narrow in on the individuals we want to engage.

- **Documenting Specific Customers:** Identifying the types of people to target is just a piece of the puzzle. In this section, we take it a step further and drilldown to individual prospects. This involves a comprehensive analysis of psychographic and behavioral traits. It's about painting a vivid picture of your audience, understanding their needs, preferences, and what success means to them.

Every marketing roadmap starts with the customer. Once we build a solid understanding of the customer, we can create owned experiences and amplify messages across a variety of channels.

Ideal target account

Enterprise Companies with Centralized Event Teams

Fortune 500 corporations with dedicated event organizations host 20+ annual engagements. They manage diverse speaker budgets from $15K to $250K+ and need bureau partners who understand their culture, deliver strategic recommendations, and support complex event portfolios across multiple business units.

Location	North America
Industry	Multi-industry (Financial Services, Technology, Consumer Goods, Professional Services)
Revenue:	$5B - $50B+
Employees:	10.000 - 100.000+
Technologies:	Salesforce, Cvent, HubSpot, Workday, SAP Concur

Ideal customer

Michelle Torres | VP of Corporate Meetings & Events @ MasterCard

Thinks

She needs speakers who anchor major initiatives and drive real impact. Her team's success depends on matching the right speaker to each audience. She worries about maintaining relationships with proven speakers while discovering fresh voices.

Says

"I need a partner who understands our culture and strategic priorities." "Can you show me speakers who've worked with financial services audiences?" "We anchor our leadership summit around one keynote—it has to be perfect."

Sees

She sees dozens of speaker proposals monthly. She sees her peers at other Fortune 500s facing similar challenges. She sees internal stakeholders with competing priorities. She sees budget pressure despite high-profile events.

Pains

Michelle struggles to maintain personalized relationships when managing 25+ annual events. She faces disconnected communication with bureaus between bookings. She deals with last-minute speaker changes and availability issues.

Feels

Michelle feels pressure to deliver memorable experiences across 25+ events annually. She feels confident when her bureau partner knows her business. She feels frustrated when vendors treat each booking as transactional.

Does

Michelle plans events 8-10 months ahead. She builds relationships with bureau partners who deliver consistently. She evaluates speakers based on audience fit and past performance.

Hears

"We need someone who can speak to our transformation journey." "Marketing wants a big name; L&D wants practical content." "Our budget got cut but expectations stayed the same."

Goals

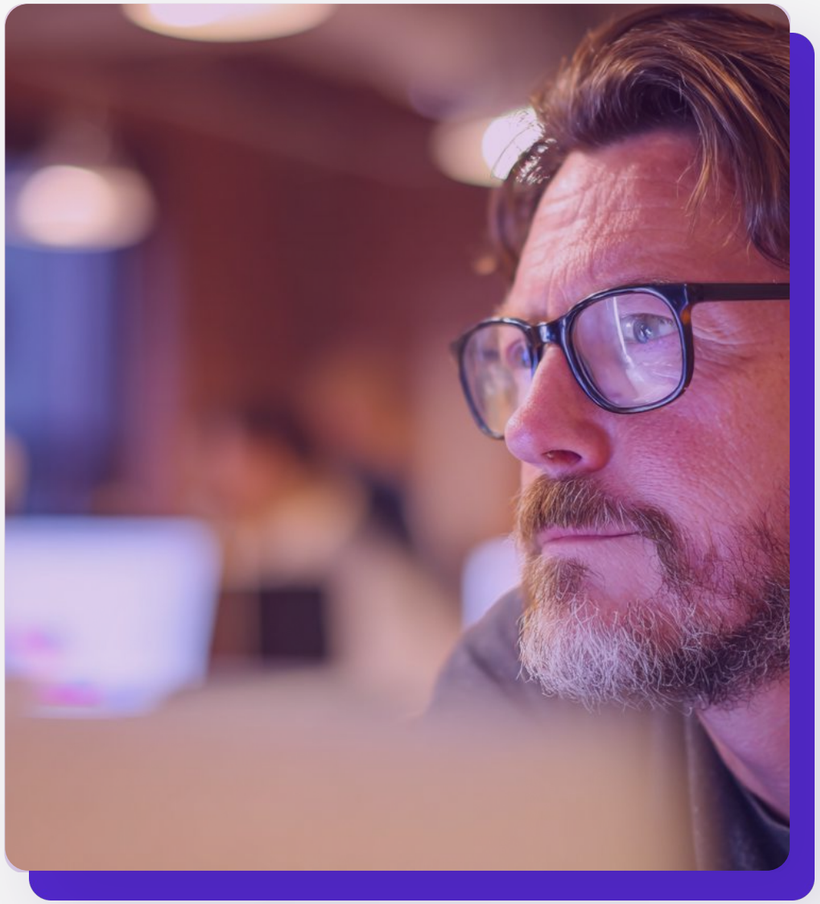
Michelle aims to build strategic partnerships with bureaus who know her business. She wants consistent communication and proactive recommendations.

Ideal target account

Financial Services Learning & Development Organizations

Banks and investment firms investing heavily in leadership development, client experiences, and corporate training. They require speakers who understand financial services dynamics and deliver content that transforms teams and engages high-value clients.

Location	North America (Major Financial Centers: New York, Chicago, San Francisco, Charlotte, Boston)
Industry	Financial Services (Banking, Investment Management, Insurance, Wealth Management)
Revenue:	$2B - $100B+
Employees:	5,000 - 50,000+
Technologies:	Salesforce Financial Services Cloud, Workday, SAP SuccessFactors, Cornerstone OnDemand, Zoom Events



Ideal customer

David Chen | Director of Leadership Development @ Fidelity Investments

Thinks

David knows great speakers drive culture change and leadership excellence. He believes content must connect to real financial services challenges. He considers how speakers will handle sophisticated, skeptical audiences.

Says

"Our executives won't engage with generic leadership content." "We need someone who understands regulatory pressures and market volatility." "Can we capture video for our learning management system?"

Sees

He sees competitors investing heavily in thought leadership and client experiences. He sees internal compliance teams scrutinizing content and contracts. He sees budgets allocated across multiple business units.

Pains

Navigates complex approval processes and contract negotiations. He manages strict compliance and legal requirements around content and recordings. He balances the need for industry-specific expertise with engaging presentation skills.

Feels

David feels accountable for developing next-generation leaders. He feels cautious about speakers who lack financial industry credibility. He feels energized when speakers deliver actionable frameworks.

Does

David books speakers 6-12 months in advance for flagship programs. He vets speakers through reference calls with similar firms. He negotiates contract terms carefully, especially video and recording rights.

Hears

"We need speakers who've advised financial institutions, not just spoken to them." "Legal redlined the recording clause again." "Our top clients expect world-class speakers at our summit."

Goals

David wants to partner with bureaus who understand financial services culture and constraints. He seeks speakers who blend industry expertise with compelling delivery.

Ideal target account

Professional Association Annual Conference Planners

Membership organizations hosting industry conferences and regional events that educate, inspire, and connect professionals. They value speakers who understand their community, deliver relevant insights, and create memorable experiences that drive member engagement and satisfaction.

Location	United States
Industry	Professional Associations (Healthcare, HR, Industry Trade Groups, Executive Networks)
Revenue (AUM):	$10M - $250M
Employees:	50 - 500
Technologies:	Nonprofit, Wild Apricot, Higher Logic, Cvent, Personify

Ideal customer

Jennifer Martinez | Director of Conferences & Events @ SHRM (Society for Human Resource Management)

Thinks

Jennifer knows the keynote speaker sets the tone for the entire conference. She considers how to balance big-name appeal with budget constraints. She evaluates which speakers will resonate with diverse member demographics.

Says

"Our members expect speakers who understand HR challenges firsthand." "We need someone who can engage 2,000 people in a ballroom." "Last year's speaker scored 4.8 out of 5; we need to maintain that standard."

Sees

She sees members comparing her conference to competitors' events. She sees budget spreadsheets with limited flexibility. She sees volunteer board members with strong opinions. She sees post-event surveys that directly impact her performance review.

Pains

Jennifer faces pressure to drive conference registrations through speaker announcements. She struggles to find speakers who deliver both credibility and engagement at her price point.

Feels

Jennifer feels pride in delivering value to members who invest time and money to attend. She feels pressure to match or exceed previous years' speaker quality. She feels responsible for using member dues wisely.

Does

Jennifer plans the annual conference 12-18 months in advance. She presents speaker options to executive committees for approval. She negotiates within fixed budget parameters. She collects member feedback and session ratings.

Hears

"Can we get someone who's been featured on major podcasts or TED?" "The board wants a name that will drive registrations." "Members loved the interactive format last year." "We need diversity in our speaker lineup."

Goals

Jennifer aims to deliver exceptional speaker experiences that drive member satisfaction scores. She wants bureau partners who respect her budget and understand her audience.

Ideal target account

Corporate Marketing Event Strategy Teams

Marketing departments orchestrating customer conferences, sales kickoffs, and brand experiences that drive business results. They seek speakers who elevate brand positioning, engage audiences authentically, and deliver content that aligns with corporate messaging and revenue goals.

Location	North America
Industry	Technology, Professional Services, Manufacturing, Healthcare, B2B Services
Revenue:	$500M - $10B
Employees:	2,000 - 20,000
Technologies:	HubSpot, Marketo, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, 6sense, ON24, Splash

Ideal customer

Sarah Williams | VP of Marketing Events & Experiences @ Deloitte

Thinks

Sarah knows speakers must reinforce brand themes and strategic messaging. She considers how speaker content will resonate on social media and in follow-up campaigns. She evaluates speakers' ability to engage C-level audiences and prospects.

Says

"Our customer conference needs a speaker who embodies innovation and transformation." "Can you show me speakers who've worked with B2B audiences?"

Sees

She sees competitors creating compelling customer experiences. She sees internal pressure to demonstrate marketing ROI. She sees sales teams looking to marketing for inspiration and momentum.

Pains

Sarah struggles to find speakers who understand B2B dynamics and corporate contexts. She navigates competing stakeholder opinions on speaker selection. She faces pressure to demonstrate clear ROI from event investments.

Feels

Sarah feels accountable for creating experiences that drive pipeline and revenue. She feels confident when speakers understand her business objectives. She feels anxious when speakers seem scripted or disconnected.

Does

Sarah books speakers 6-9 months before major events. She collaborates with sales leadership on kickoff speaker selection. She creates detailed briefs outlining audience profiles and business objectives.

Hears

"We need someone who can fire up the sales team before a critical quarter." "Our customers want forward-thinking perspectives, not sales pitches." "Can the speaker mention our new platform without making it feel promotional?"

Goals

Sarah aims to create event experiences that drive measurable business outcomes. She wants speakers who enhance brand positioning and thought leadership.

Brand positioning & messaging

Your ideal customers have a lot of choices in the market. So establishing a distinct and resonant brand story is more than just a task; it's a crucial part of everything we develop down the road.

This section is where we craft the narrative of your brand, a story that not only distinguishes you in the marketplace but deeply resonates with your target audience.

We leverage the *Storybrand* framework and use it to carve out a unique space for your brand in the minds of your customers.

Here's what this section encompasses:

- **Understanding the Character:** At the heart of your brand's story is the primary character (or "hero").

  The hero is your ideal customer.

- **Crafting the Story:** Once the character is outlined, we use techniques to establish your brand as the guide on their journey. We uncover how your brand plays a role in transforming your customer from what state to another.

Ultimately, your brand's story helps:

- Provide a human connection
- Highlight differences between your brand and competitors (or alternatives)
- Build trust and loyalty
- Establish a foundation for all communication (owned experiences and messages amplified in channels such as ABM, Paid, Social, and SEO

Washington Speakers Bureau Brand Canvas

Your Customer

Event leaders want the perfect speaker who delivers memorable experiences, aligns with their strategic objectives, and resonates deeply with their specific audience.

Has a Challenge

Villain: The transactional approach to speaker booking that treats every engagement as one-and-done rather than building strategic relationships.

External problem: Finding speakers who truly fit their audience, coordinating across multiple stakeholders, managing diverse budgets and event types.

Internal problem: Fear of selecting a speaker who doesn't connect with their audience, feeling abandoned between bookings.

Philosophical: Every event represents an investment in people and culture. Audiences deserve speakers who understand their challenges and deliver content that creates lasting impact.

Finds Your Company

Empathy: Washington Speakers Bureau understands the pressure of delivering flawless events across diverse portfolios. We know you're coordinating multiple stakeholders, managing tight timelines, and seeking partners who proactively support your success, not just respond to requests.

Authority: With 45+ years of experience, 200 exclusive speakers, and trusted relationships with Fortune 500 companies and leading associations, WSB has placed more than 100k speakers in 67 countries around the world.

You Give Them a Plan

Process: WSB provides strategic consultation to understand your audience and objectives, delivers curated speaker recommendations based on proven fit, handles all logistics seamlessly, and maintains proactive communication throughout your event calendar—not just during bookings.

Agreement or guarantee: We commit to relationship-focused partnerships that grow with your needs. You'll receive strategic recommendations tailored to your organization, ongoing communication between events, and dedicated support that treats every booking as part of your larger story.

You Call Them to Action

Direct: Partner with Washington Speakers Bureau for your next speaking engagement. Get a custom proposal.

Transitional or secondary: Explore our exclusive speaker roster or sign up for our newsletter.

To Experience Success

- Perfect speaker-audience alignment that drives engagement and business results
- Strategic partnership that understands your culture and anticipates your needs
- Access to world-class speakers who anchor corporate initiatives and create lasting impact
- Proactive recommendations that introduce you to speakers before you even know you need them

And Avoid Failure

- Wasting budget on speakers who don't connect with your specific audience
- Last-minute availability crises and scrambling for replacements
- Transactional relationships that leave you unsupported until your next booking request

You Help Transform Your Customer

From: Managing speaker bookings transactionally with uncertainty about selection, feeling unsupported between events, and lacking a partner who truly understands their organizational needs.

To: Strategic partnership with confidence in every booking decision, proactive support throughout the year, and a trusted guide who knows their culture and delivers consistent excellence.

Products & solutions

It's important to document how you help your ideal customers overcome their challenges.

This section delineates the array of products and solutions your brand offers, casting a spotlight on their potential to transform the customer from a negative to a positive state.

Central to this section is the comprehensive Products & Solutions Matrix, a tool designed to offer a clear, concise overview of each product's role in the customer's journey.

This matrix is structured to provide insights into:

- **Product:** A detailed description of each product, highlighting its unique features and capabilities.
- **Specific Challenges the Product Helps Overcome:** This attribute identifies the major pain points customers face and why the product exists.
- **How the Product Provides a Picture of Success:** Here, we paint a vivid picture of the potential success that customers can achieve through the utilization of the product, fostering a positive and aspirational outlook.
- **How the Product Helps Avoid Failure:** This segment focuses on the preventative aspects of the product, illustrating how it can help users sidestep common pitfalls and failures, thereby securing a smoother path to their goals.

By taking the time to document products in this way, we set up a foundation for messaging in ABM, Paid Media, SEO, and Social channels.

Products & solutions matrix

Product/Solution	Helps Overcome these Challenges	Provides this Picture of Success	Helps Avoid this Failure
Strategic Speaker Partnership	Event leaders struggle with transactional bureau relationships that leave them unsupported between bookings. They lack partners who understand their organizational culture, anticipate their needs across 20+ annual events, and provide proactive recommendations. They coordinate multiple stakeholders while managing diverse budgets and objectives without strategic guidance throughout their event calendar.	Your bureau partner knows your business, proactively recommends speakers before you even ask, and maintains consistent communication year-round. You receive strategic consultation that aligns speakers with corporate initiatives, builds on past successes, and introduces you to emerging talent that fits your specific culture and audience needs.	Avoid last-minute scrambling for speakers, missed opportunities to anchor corporate initiatives around compelling content, and transactional relationships that treat every booking as a one-off transaction. Prevent the frustration of explaining your organization's needs repeatedly to partners who never truly understand your business.
Exclusive Speaker Access	Organizations face limited access to world-class thought leaders and proven speakers who can anchor major initiatives. They compete for availability of top-tier talent, struggle to discover speakers before they become oversaturated, and lack direct relationships with speakers who can customize content for their specific needs and deliver consistent excellence.	You gain priority access to 200 exclusive speakers—including bestselling authors, Fortune 500 executives, and renowned thought leaders—who work closely with WSB to customize content. You book speakers who align perfectly with your objectives, deliver exceptional audience engagement, and create lasting impact that drives your strategic initiatives forward across all events.	Avoid settling for second-choice speakers due to availability constraints, booking speakers who deliver generic content that fails to resonate, and missing opportunities to secure emerging thought leaders before they become inaccessible or prohibitively expensive for your budget range.

Products & solutions matrix

Product/Solution	Helps Overcome these Challenges	Provides this Picture of Success	Helps Avoid this Failure
Custom Speaker Curation & Topic Expertise	Event planners struggle to find speakers who address specific themes, industry challenges, or audience demographics beyond big-name celebrities. They waste time researching hundreds of options, lack confidence in speaker quality for specialized topics, and need guidance matching speakers to diverse audience types across their event portfolio with varying budgets and objectives.	You receive curated speaker recommendations tailored to your specific topic, audience, and budget—whether you need AI experts for healthcare audiences, leadership speakers for financial services, or motivational voices for sales kickoffs. Every recommendation comes with insights on why this speaker fits your needs, backed by proven performance with similar audiences.	Avoid booking speakers who miss the mark on content relevance, wasting budget on mismatched talent that doesn't connect with your specific audience, and the disappointment of generic presentations that could have been delivered to any industry or demographic without customization or impact.
Full-Service Speaker Event Logistics & Coordination	Organizations manage complex speaker logistics across multiple events, coordinate travel and contracts, navigate legal and compliance requirements, and handle last-minute changes without dedicated support. They lack streamlined processes for video rights, speaker briefings, and post-event coordination while managing internal stakeholder expectations and competing priorities throughout the planning cycle.	You experience seamless execution from initial consultation through post-event follow-up. WSB handles all contracts, travel logistics, speaker briefings, and coordination with your internal teams. Your speakers arrive prepared, deliver exceptional presentations, and you receive support managing any last-minute adjustments—all while maintaining clear communication with your stakeholders.	Avoid contract disputes and compliance issues, last-minute speaker cancellations without backup options, logistics failures that create day-of-event chaos, and the frustration of coordinating complex requirements alone across multiple business units and stakeholder groups with competing demands.

Competition

A well-rounded marketing roadmap is built not only on the strengths and offerings of your own organization but also on a profound understanding of the movements and positions of competitors in the market.

Even though the competition won't drive decisions we make, it can inform how we construct specific campaigns or implement various tactics.

This section is dedicated to offering a succinct yet insightful glimpse into the key players who share the market space with your brand, providing a vantage point to craft strategies that are both informed and adaptive.

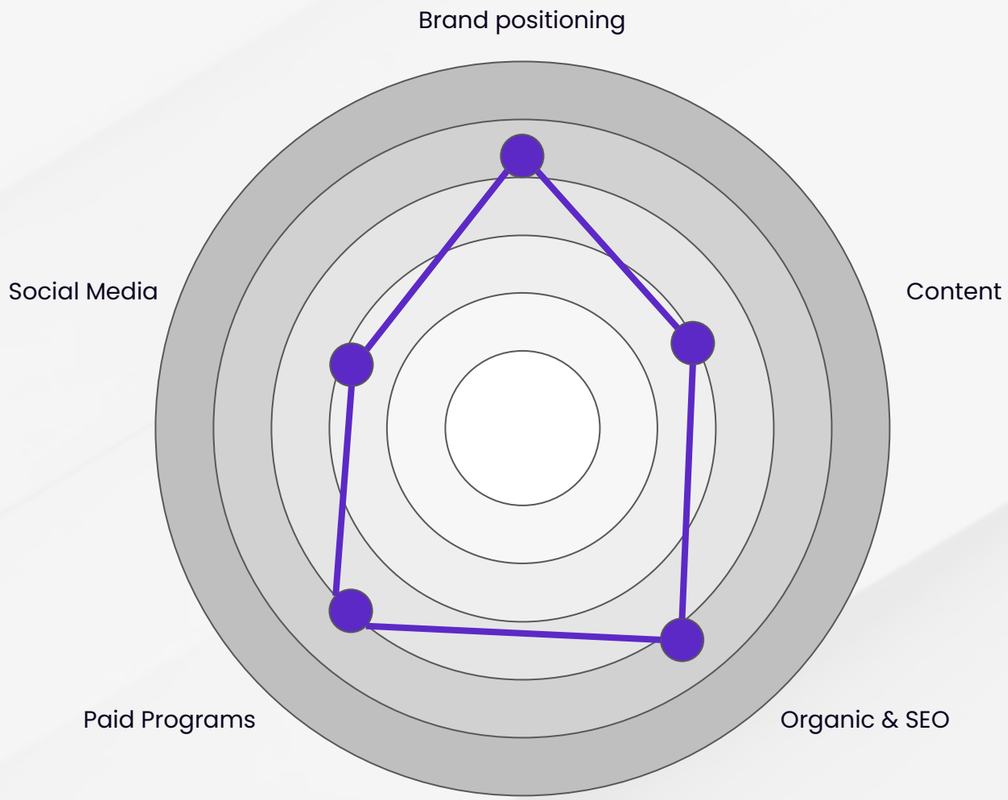
While this section doesn't delve deep into a comprehensive competitive analysis, it serves as a vital tool to identify and monitor significant competitors in the market.

By keeping a close eye on these entities, we can glean valuable insights into market trends, customer preferences, and potential areas of collaboration or differentiation.

In this section, we present how each competitor tracks along five distinct dimensions, including:

- Organic search & SEO
- Content
- Paid media
- Social media
- Brand positioning & messaging

All American Speakers

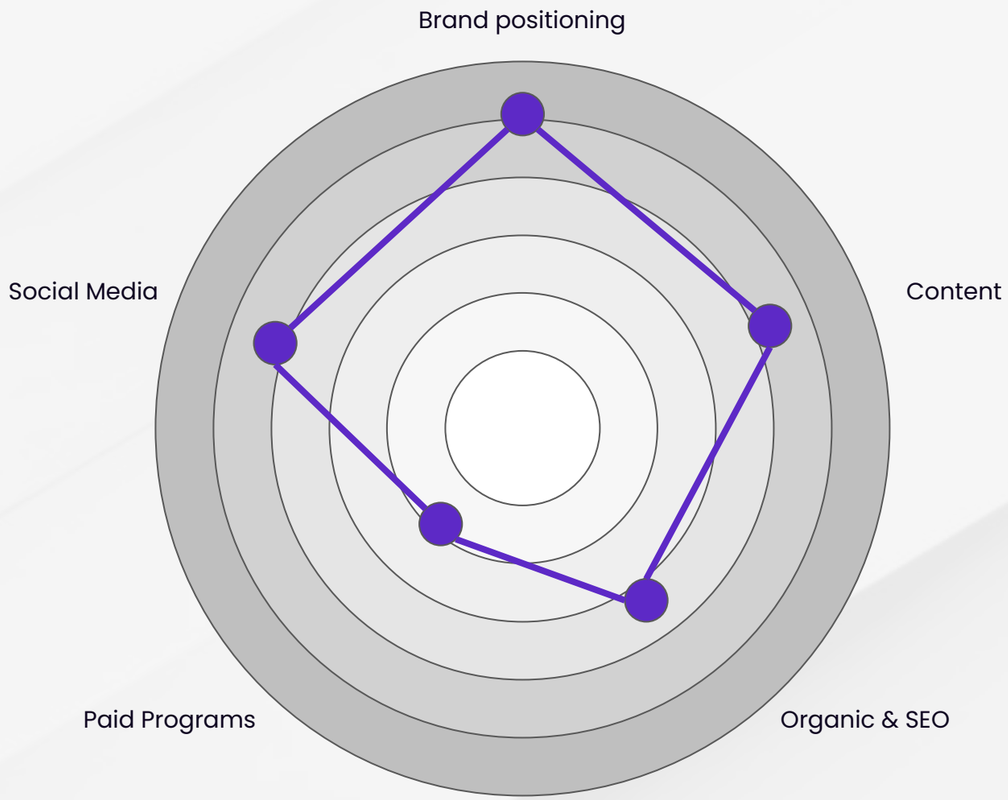


All American Speakers leads specialized speaker bureaus in SEO authority with Domain Authority of 58 and 9,030 linking root domains—nearly double WSB's portfolio. The full-service bureau competes directly in corporate speaking with 55 employees. However, significantly smaller social media presence and limited content marketing investment create vulnerabilities despite superior organic search performance and extensive backlink profile.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 58/100 highest among specialized bureaus, edges WSB's 57/100
- 9,030 linking root domains nearly 2x WSB's 4,558, superior link acquisition
- LinkedIn following 6,605 vs WSB 11,203, indicating weaker social strategy
- YouTube presence limited: 286 subscribers, 95 videos vs WSB's 2,330/607
- Overall competitive score 4.8/10, strongest in Organic SEO (6.5/10), weakest Content (3.4/10)

Big Speak

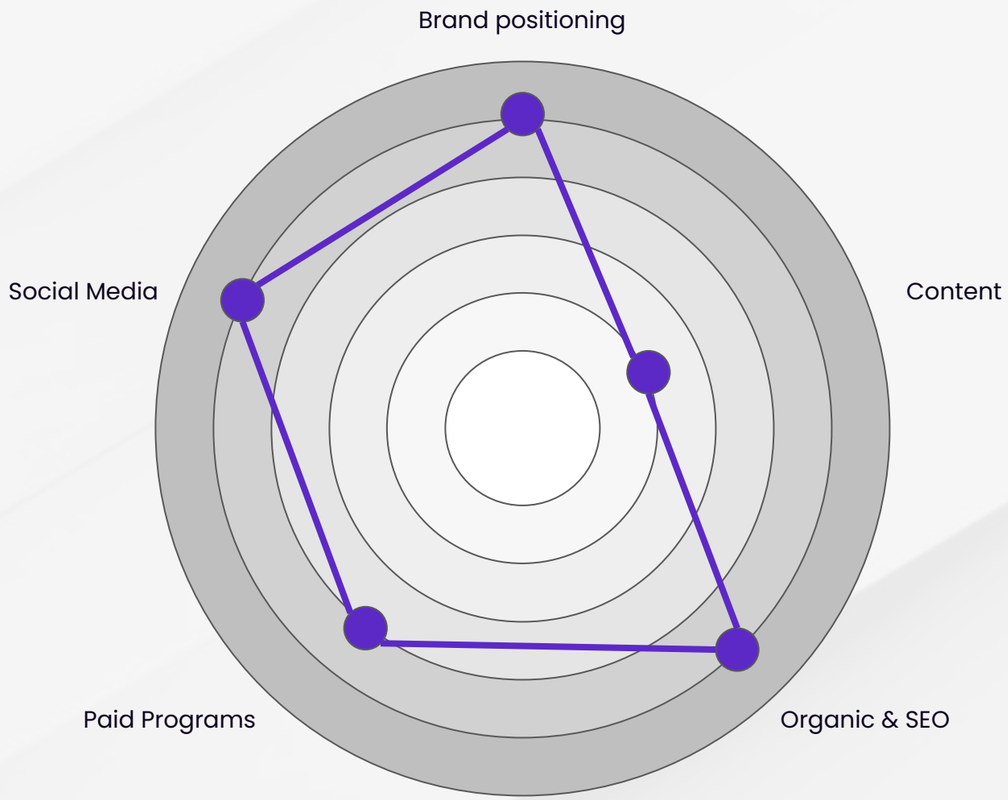


Big Speak dominates content marketing with industry's largest video library: 62,500 YouTube subscribers and 2,983 videos, creating massive SEO advantages and organic discovery opportunities. The 34-employee bureau achieved highest overall competitive score (7.0/10) through content-first strategy. Despite content leadership, Domain Authority of 54 trails WSB (57) and All American Speakers (58), suggesting content volume doesn't fully translate to technical authority.

Key Insights:

- YouTube dominance: 62,500 subscribers and 2,983 videos, 27x larger than WSB
- LinkedIn following 16,802 exceeds WSB's 11,203, 50% larger professional network
- Content Strategy scored 9.5/10, highest across all competitors and dimensions
- Domain Authority 54/100 trails WSB despite massive content investment volume
- Represents HIGH threat through content marketing but quality-over-quantity opportunity for WSB.

Creative Artists Agency (CAA)

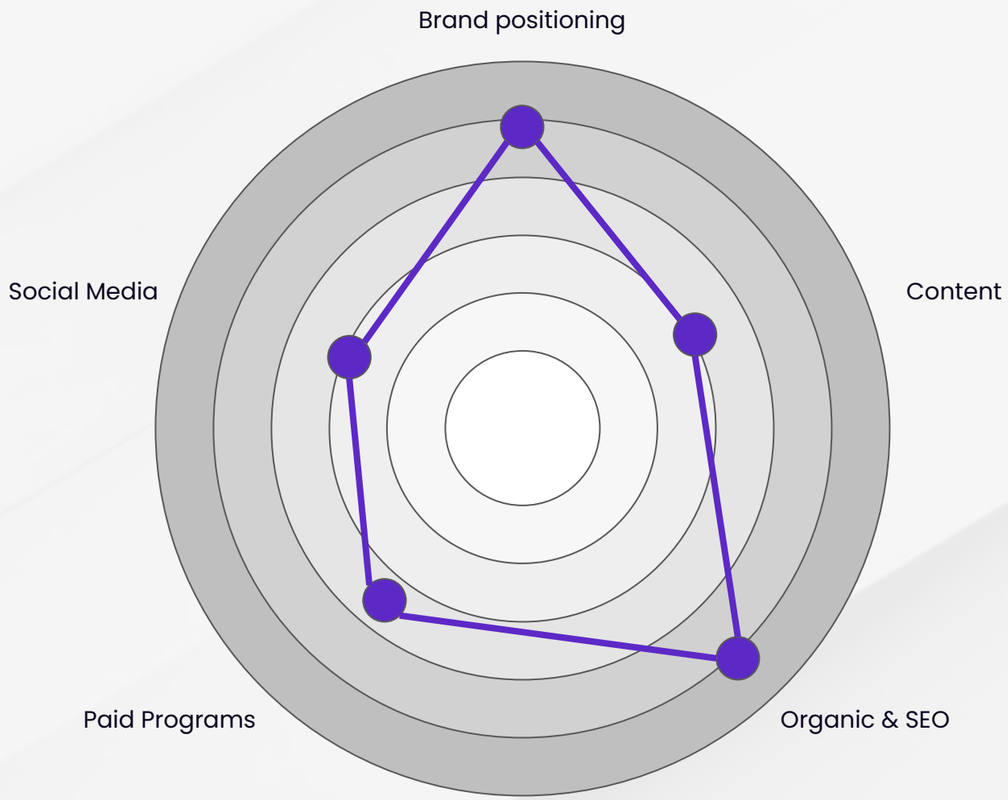


CAA operates speaker representation as one division within diversified entertainment portfolio of 1,815 employees. Achieves highest Domain Authority (65/100) and LinkedIn following (353,499) in competitive landscape, reflecting decades of entertainment industry presence. However, speaker division captures only fraction of this authority. Limited content marketing investment (75 videos, 319 YouTube subscribers) and broad entertainment focus versus corporate speaking specialization create competitive opportunities for focused bureaus.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 65/100 highest in competitive set, 2.6x more domains than WSB
- LinkedIn followers 353,499 dwarf all competitors, 32x larger than WSB's 11,203
- Brand Positioning scored 8.6/10, reflecting entertainment industry authority and broad recognition
- YouTube presence minimal: 319 subscribers, 75 videos despite overall brand strength
- MEDIUM threat—entertainment focus dilutes corporate speaking specialization, creating specialist positioning opportunity

The Harry Walker Agency

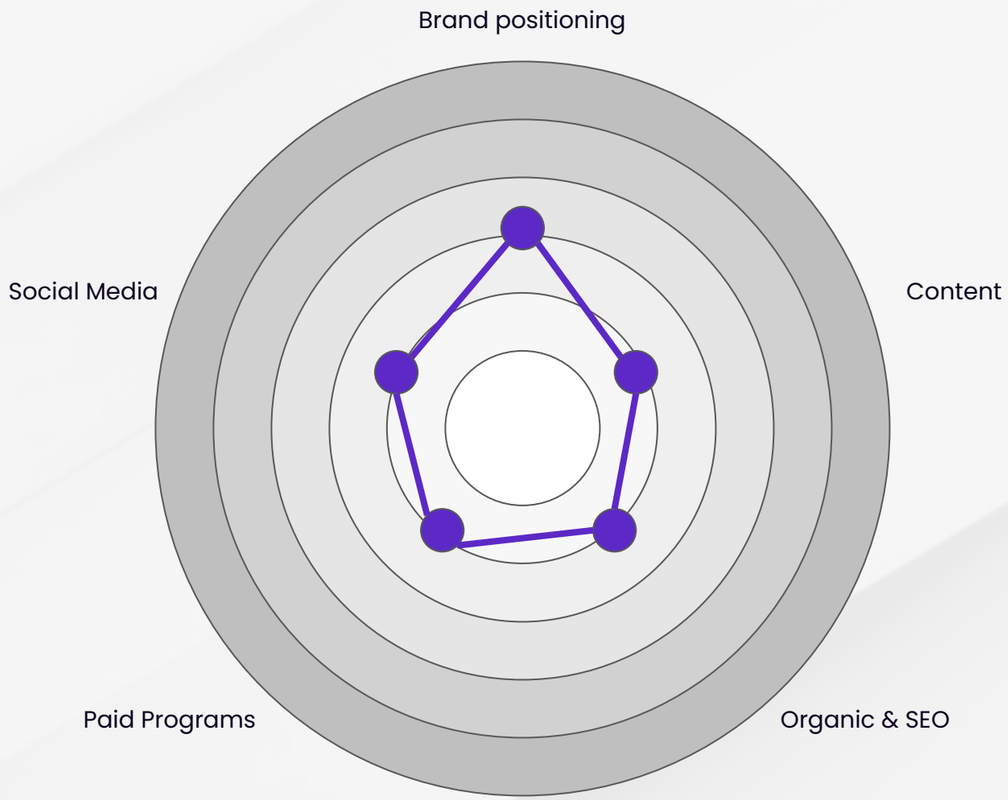


Harry Walker Agency achieves highest Domain Authority (59/100) among specialized speaker bureaus, representing premium segment with exclusive high-profile talent roster. The 50-employee agency competes directly with WSB in premium corporate speaking through quality-over-volume link acquisition strategy (4,404 domains). Moderate social media presence (5,952 LinkedIn followers, 809 YouTube subscribers) and balanced content approach position HWA as consistent premium competitor.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 59/100 highest among specialized bureaus, edges All American (58)
- LinkedIn following 5,952 significantly below WSB's 11,203, weaker social engagement
- YouTube presence moderate: 809 subscribers, 399 videos between WSB and Big Speak
- Overall score 5.2/10, consistent across dimensions without dominant strengths or weaknesses
- MEDIUM-HIGH threat in premium segment, opportunity in broader market coverage

United Talent Agency (UTA)

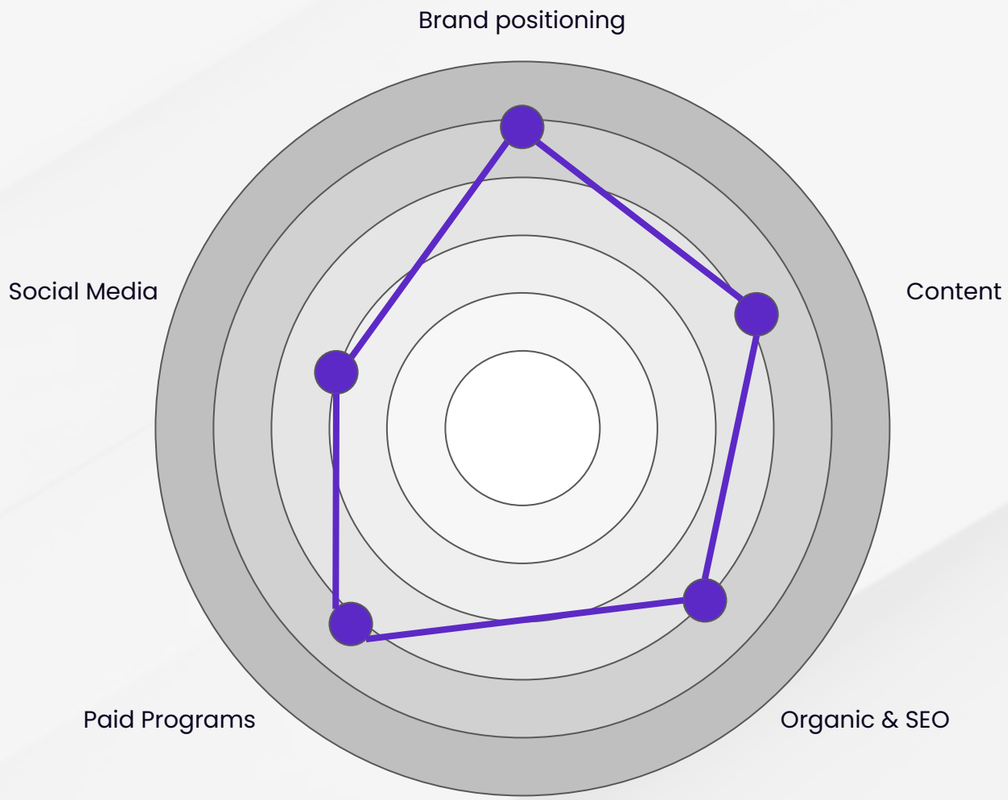


UTA Speakers operates as division of entertainment agency with 40 employees, exhibiting significant digital marketing deficits across all dimensions. Lowest Domain Authority (48/100), smallest backlink portfolio (1,424 domains), elevated spam score (13%), and minimal content presence (1 YouTube video, 64 subscribers) create substantial competitive gaps. Entertainment industry relationships provide some advantage not reflected in digital metrics, but current presence suggests limited corporate speaking focus.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 48/100 lowest in competitive set, only 1,424 linking domains
- LinkedIn followers 2,857 smallest among competitors, weakest professional network presence
- YouTube essentially non-existent: 64 subscribers, 1 video, no content strategy
- Overall score 3.2/10 lowest across all competitors in every dimension
- LOW threat—digital marketing deficits create validation for WSB's content investment strategy

Washington Speakers Bureau (WSB)



Washington Speakers Bureau positions as the world's largest talent agency specializing exclusively in corporate speaking events with 45+ years of industry leadership and 127 employees. Achieves balanced competitive performance across dimensions with Domain Authority 57/100, 4,558 linking domains, and substantial content investment (607 YouTube videos, 2,330 subscribers). Strongest performance in Brand Positioning (6.1/10) and Paid Media Strategy (6.0/10) reflects established market presence, though content marketing and social media present growth opportunities versus aggressive competitors.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 57/100 strong mid-tier, trailing Harry Walker (59) and CAA (65)
- LinkedIn following 11,203 second highest among specialized bureaus, behind Big Speak's 16,802
- YouTube content library substantial: 607 videos, 2,330 subscribers, 631,891 total views
- Paid Media Strategy scored 6.0/10, highest among competitors with available data
- Overall score 5.7/10 balanced across dimensions, greatest opportunity in Content (5.5) and Social (5.4)

Roadmap

In this section, we outline a clear, structured method for setting and achieving your organization's primary long-term goals. This approach is crucial for the marketing roadmap because it fosters alignment, ensures measurable progress, and drives meaningful outcomes by linking strategic marketing initiatives directly to specific, ambitious, and actionable goals.

Setting the right goals

At Marketers in Demand, we use OKRs, or Objectives and Key Results as a vehicle to set and achieve goals. It's a clear, straightforward approach used by teams and individuals to set ambitious goals and track measurable results. OKRs create alignment, boost engagement, and ensure progress towards significant outcomes.

Objectives

An Objective is what you aim to achieve. It's significant, concrete, and action-oriented. It's the clear goal post you're aiming for, providing direction and inspiration. Objectives cut through ambiguity, offering a defined path towards achievement.

Key Results

Key Results are the measurable steps you take to reach your objective. They are specific, time-bound, and realistic, leaving no room for doubt. You either meet them or you don't. They provide a clear measure of progress, ensuring you're on the right path towards achieving your Objective.

How We Write OKRs

We try to make OKRs as simple as possible to understand. We start with your Objective, and then list 1-2 Key Results that will help you achieve it. Or, frame it as a statement: "I will (Objective) as measured by (Key Results)." This clear, concise format ensures everyone knows what needs to be done and how success will be measured.

The Power of OKRs

OKRs are a powerful tool for setting clear goals, tracking progress, and ensuring success throughout each quarter. They provide a solid framework for achievement, ensuring everyone is aligned, engaged, and working towards meaningful outcomes.

Annual goal alignment

Business Outcome	Metric	Description	Benchmark	Annual Goal	Where is the Data?
Increase Marketing-Attributed Pipeline	Marketing-Attributed Opportunities Created	Total opportunities/deals created that have a trackable digital source (Paid Search, Organic Search, Direct Traffic, Referrals, Email Marketing) in HubSpot. Excludes "Offline Sources" and “Other” which represent traditional referrals and agent-sourced leads with no digital touchpoint.	TTM 2025: ~2,580 opportunities from trackable digital sources (Direct 853 + Organic Search 852 + Paid Search 591 + Referrals 259 + Email Marketing 25 + Organic Social minimal). This represents 30% of total pipeline; 68% currently shows "Offline Sources" due to attribution gaps.	25% increase in marketing-attributed opportunities (Target: ~3,225 opportunities from trackable digital sources)	HubSpot: Deal records filtered by "Original Traffic Source" excluding "Offline Sources"; Salesforce: Opportunity-level reporting synced to HubSpot
Reactivate Dormant Accounts	Opportunities from Reactivated Accounts	New opportunities created from accounts that haven't had a closed-won deal in 12+ months. These reactivated opportunities count toward the primary goal above, making this a key lever for achieving the 25% increase.	Current: 7,269 companies in HubSpot with most recent deal close date over 12 months ago. Minimal systematic reactivation efforts currently in place.	250+ new opportunities from reactivated accounts (accounts with no closed-won deal in prior 12 months)	HubSpot: New opportunities where associated company's last closed-won deal date is 12+ months prior; requires company-level "Recent deal close date" field or deal history analysis

Rationale

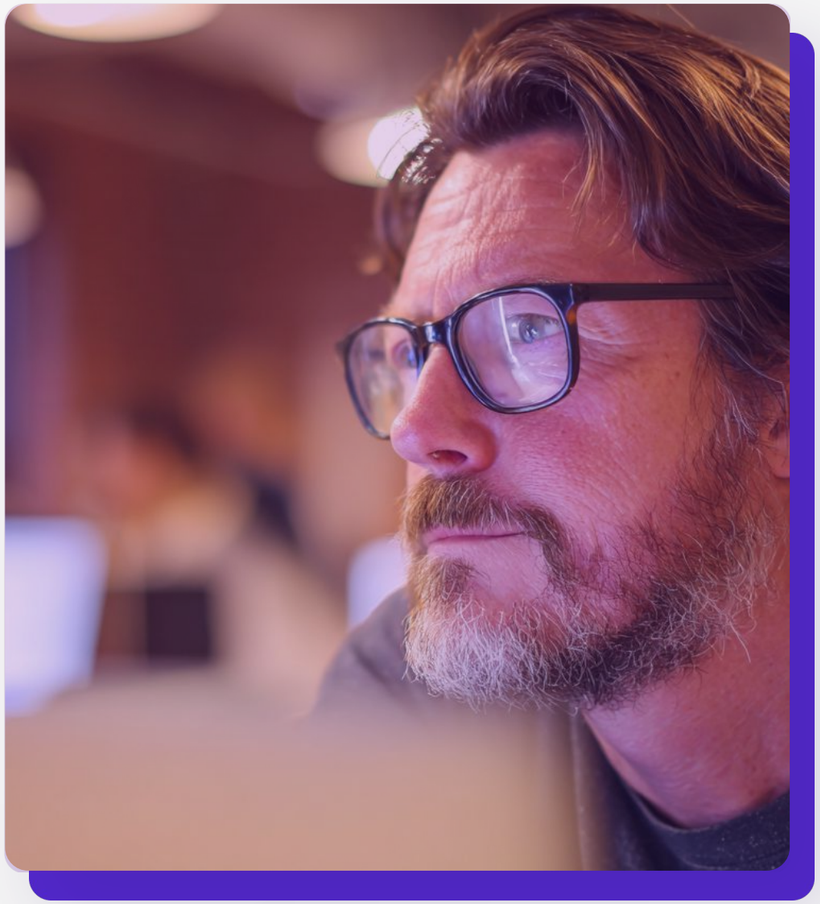
Primary Goal: 25% Increase in Marketing-Attributed Opportunities

- **Stage-Appropriate for Current State:** WSB is transitioning from a purely relationship-driven, inbound-dependent business model (80% referral-based per leadership) to one requiring proactive marketing infrastructure. With minimal digital marketing investment today, there's substantial room to capture net-new demand through both acquisition and reactivation channels.
- **Pipeline/Revenue Alignment:** Based on CRM analysis, WSB generated $23.4M in TTM revenue from 3,353 closed-won deals at an average deal size of ~$10,700 and a 38.5% close rate. A 25% increase in marketing-attributed opportunities (~645 additional opportunities) could translate to ~248 additional closed deals and ~$2.7M incremental revenue assuming current conversion rates hold.
- **Two Pathways to Achievement:** The 25% target can be reached through a combination of net-new acquisition (accounts that have never booked with WSB) and dormant account reactivation (the supporting goal below). This dual approach de-risks the target by not relying solely on new customer acquisition.

Rationale

Supporting Goal: 250+ Opportunities from Reactivated Accounts

- **Massive Dormant Account Pool:** HubSpot data shows 7,269 companies with no closed deal in the past 12 months. Even a modest 3.4% reactivation rate on this pool would achieve the 250-opportunity target—well below the industry benchmark of 5-10% for winback campaigns with proper nurture programs.
- **Lower Acquisition Cost, Higher Intent:** These accounts already know WSB, have engaged before, and don't require top-of-funnel education. Reactivating a dormant account typically costs 5-7x less than acquiring a net-new customer, and these contacts are already in the database ready for nurture campaigns.
- **Addresses WSB's Stated Retention Challenge:** Leadership identified that ~90% of accounts opened 3 years ago never returned. The 250-opportunity target demonstrates marketing's direct impact on this business problem.
- **Absolute Number vs. Percentage:** We're targeting 250+ opportunities rather than a percentage because (a) the 7,269-company pool includes varying definitions of "dormant" that need refinement, (b) an absolute target is easier to track and report, and (c) 250 opportunities represents meaningful contribution (~39%) to the incremental growth needed for the primary goal.



Quarterly initiatives

Objective	Why?	Key Results
Establish Marketing Operations Infrastructure	Current HubSpot-Salesforce integration has gaps, leading to 68% of deals showing "Offline Sources" with no marketing attribution. Without proper tracking, we cannot measure progress toward either goal or distinguish between net new and reactivated opportunities.	• **KR1:** Audit and adjust/enhance HubSpot-Salesforce sync if needed by end of January; create custom fields to support additional reporting (“custom_source”) • **KR2:** Launch marketing attribution dashboard tracking opportunities by source, with segmentation for "net new accounts" vs. "reactivated accounts" (no closed-won deal in 12+ months)—enabling measurement of both primary and supporting goals • **KR3:** Implement RB2B, Factors.ai or similar de-anonymization tool to capture account-level website visitor data
Launch Thought Leadership Content Engine	Rather than compete on volume with other players in the industry, WSB should establish quality-focused thought leadership that positions the brand as a strategic partner. This content serves both net new acquisition (SEO, social reach) and reactivation (newsletter to existing database).	• **KR1:** Publish monthly "State of the Speaking Industry" pillar content piece (blog + email + LinkedIn distribution) with internal interviews, generating organic and paid social engagement activity • **KR2:** Launch bi-weekly email newsletter to existing database (goal: 25% open rate, 3% CTR) featuring speaker insights, event trends, and curated recommendations—serving as primary reactivation touchpoint for dormant contacts • **KR3:** Create 3 evergreen content pieces for Webflow site migration: "Why Work With a Speaker Bureau," "How to Choose the Right Keynote Speaker," and "2026 Event Trends" guide

Quarterly initiatives

Objective	Why?	Key Results
Activate Sales Enablement & Agent Support	Agents have been operating reactively with "order-taking" behavior rather than proactive outreach. They lack templates, sequences, and supporting content to systematically nurture their books of business—critical for both new prospect conversion and dormant account reactivation.	• **KR1:** Deploy customizable HubSpot email sequence templates (new contact outreach, dormant account re-engagement, speaker recommendation, event follow-up, budget objection handling) with 50%+ agent adoption by end of Q1 • **KR2:** Create speaker one-pagers featuring current positioning aligned to market demand (AI/leadership/motivation topics) in new template format • **KR3:** Segment the 7,269 dormant accounts by recency and value; create prioritized winback target list of top 1,000 accounts (12-36 months dormant with prior booking history) for Q2 campaign launch
Pilot Account-Based Marketing Program	WSB has identified tier 1/2/3 accounts through agent strategic planning exercises but lacks marketing air cover to support these relationships. “Cold email”, LinkedIn sequencing and targeted paid programs, provide a scalable approach for awareness and engagement for both prospect accounts (net new) and dormant accounts (reactivation).	• **KR1:** Build target account list from agent nominations (top 5 × 13 agents + WSB-owned priority accounts) uploaded to HubSpot and synced to LinkedIn—flagged as "active," "prospect," or "dormant" status • **KR2:** Launch pilot LinkedIn campaign targeting Financial Services ICP segment (and one other cohort of “new logos”) with custom ad creatives; achieve 0.5% engagement rate and 10+ identified accounts showing engagement signals • **KR3:** Deliver monthly "ABM Signals Report" to WSB showing which target accounts (both prospects and dormant) are engaging with ads, visiting website, and opening emails—enabling proactive outreach with context

Quarterly initiatives

Objective	Why?	Key Results
Launch Video Content Program to Drive Engagement and Differentiation	Speakers are dynamic and WSB's product lends itself well to visual mediums. A multi-format video program builds brand authority, supports sales enablement, drives organic reach, and creates reusable content across channels. WSB has existing video production capacity, but they are largely focused on supporting marketing efforts for speakers. This initiative allows WSB to take advantage of MiD's video production workflow to build out content to support its own brand.	• **KR1:** Launch "Speakers on Speaking" (working title) interview series featuring 3 exclusive WSB speakers per month discussing industry trends, event planning insights, and behind-the-scenes perspectives; publish on YouTube, LinkedIn, and wsb.com with 1,000+ views per episode target • **KR2:** Resurrect and rebrand WSB's previous video podcast as a monthly thought leadership show; produce 3 episodes in Q1 featuring WSB leadership and/or top speakers discussing the state of the events industry, booking trends, and what makes events successful • **KR3:** Create internal thought leadership video series ("WSB Insider" or similar) with agents and staff sharing expertise—speaker selection tips, event planning best practices, topic trend analysis; produce short-form videos (2-3 min) for social distribution • **KR4:** Develop standardized speaker reel production process and create/update speaker or "industry" sizzle reels in new branded format; track reel engagement and correlation to booking inquiries • **KR5:** Establish video content calendar and distribution workflow ensuring all video assets are repurposed across YouTube, LinkedIn, email newsletter, website, and agent outreach materials

Quarterly initiatives

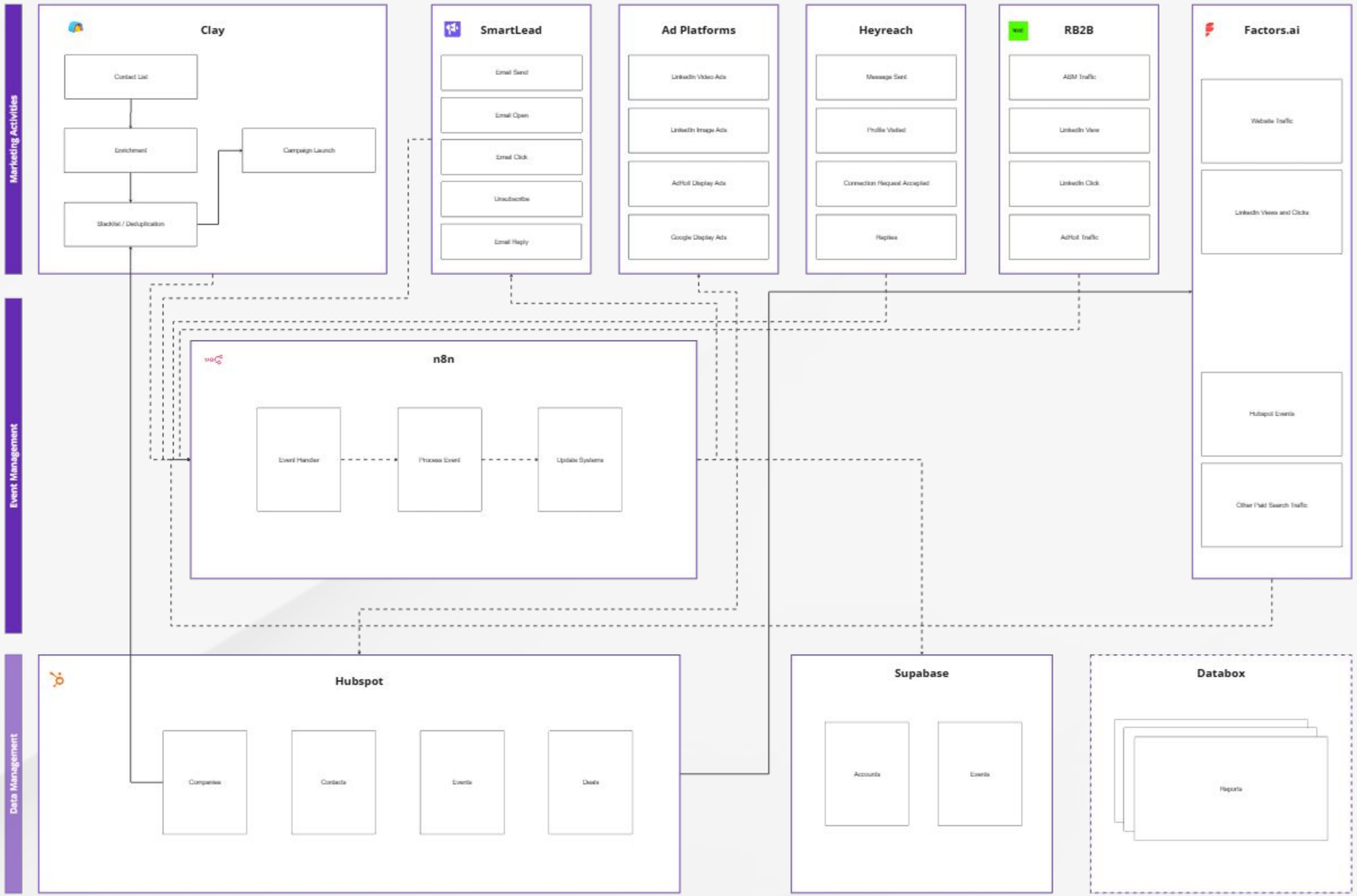
Objective	Why?	Key Results
Launch Paid Advertising Program for Broader Market Reach	The ABM program (Objective 4) targets a defined list of ~200 high-value accounts, but WSB's total addressable market is much larger—thousands of organizations booking keynote speakers annually. A broader paid advertising program captures demand from event planners actively searching for speakers and builds awareness among the wider ICP audience, driving net-new opportunities beyond the named account list.	• **KR1:** Launch or maintain Google Ads campaign targeting high-intent keywords (e.g., "keynote speaker for corporate event," "motivational speaker booking," "leadership speaker for conference") with $3-5K/month ongoing budget • **KR2:** Deploy LinkedIn Sponsored Content campaign targeting broader ICP criteria (HR leaders, event planners, L&D professionals at companies 500+ employees) beyond ABM list; generate impressions and drive website visits to foster growth towards new logo opportunities (up to $10k in monthly spend across campaigns) • **KR3:** Implement retargeting program across Google Display Network and LinkedIn for website visitors who viewed speaker profiles but didn't convert • **KR4:** Support an “always on” custom audience in LinkedIn (perhaps other channels) that ensures WSB remains in front of active accounts • **KR5:** Establish paid media reporting dashboard tracking spend, impressions, clicks, leads, and opportunities by channel; deliver weekly performance updates with optimization recommendations

Quarterly initiatives

Objective	Why?	Key Results
Build SEO Foundation and Prepare for AI-Powered Search (AEO)	WSB's Domain Authority (57) is competitive with specialized bureaus but trails competitors and lacks the content depth to fully capitalize on organic search. More critically, the search landscape is shifting—AI-powered answer engines (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Bing Copilot) are increasingly how decision-makers research speakers and bureaus. Organizations that optimize for both traditional SEO and Answer Engine Optimization (AEO) will capture demand from buyers who never click through to a website. The new website project present a unique opportunity to preserve existing SEO equity while also providing an opportunity to enrich the content for AEO.	• **KR1:** Complete comprehensive SEO audit of wsb.com covering technical SEO (site speed, mobile experience, crawlability, indexation), on-page SEO (title tags, meta descriptions, header structure, internal linking), and content gaps; deliver prioritized recommendations report by end of January • **KR2:** Develop SEO content strategy targeting high-value keywords (e.g., "keynote speakers for [industry]," "best motivational speakers," "how to book a keynote speaker"); identify 20 priority keywords with search volume and difficulty analysis; create content briefs for top 10 opportunities • **KR3:** Establish AEO baseline by auditing WSB's presence in AI answer engines (use specific AEO tools to identify relevant queries in ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews); document current citation frequency and identify content gaps where competitors are being cited instead • **KR4:** Perform standard SEO / AEO maintenance (internal linking updates, backlinking opportunities, keyword tracking, etc.) on a monthly basis and identify ongoing opportunities for optimization and new content initiatives

Marketing infrastructure

This integrated martech stack orchestrates ABM through Clay's data enrichment, feeding qualified leads into SmartLead's outbound campaigns. Ad platforms (LinkedIn, Google, Meta) and Heyreach drive top-of-funnel awareness, while RB2B identifies anonymous website visitors. Factors.ai provides account attribution insights across touchpoints such as website visits and ad platforms. All systems sync through n8n's workflow automation into Hubspot, with Supabase handling data operations and custom reporting stored in Databox—creating a unified “scrappy” attribution process from first touch to closed deal.



Proposed pricing

Description	Price	Points	Total Price
Monthly Marketing Services* A set of *200 points* can be used across a variety of different marketing tasks, including research, strategy, foundation, execution, etc. A full list of tasks and deliverables is available on Marketers in Demand's website.	$100.00	200	$20,000.00
A set of *60 points* can be used across additional marketing tasks. These points are "gifted" back to Washington Speakers Bureau in the first month once moving forward after the Aligned Growth Engine project.	$0.00	60	$0.00
Gifted points to WSB from MiD for first quarter ($7,000 value)	$0.00	70	$0.00
Monthly gifted points to WSB from MiD starting in second quarter of working together ($1,500 per month value)	$0.00	15	$0.00
Total fee per month			**$20,000.00**

Key activities for the quarter

With one monthly price, you get access to a team who can develop a strategy and execute it. Our flexible points model allows you to balance short and long-term goals. And we get to double-down on what works and pivot when we need to.

The points model gives your team complete visibility into the value of every single task. Don't worry about how many hours our team spends on a task — you will only get charged for the amount of points listed for each line item.

To set the stage for the engagement, we have outlined a list of tasks we will complete in the first three months.

[3-Month Budget Plan]

Task	Description	Points
Develop Marketing Research Document	Consolidate qualitative and quantitative research, identify strategic marketing opportunities and present key findings.	30
Develop Marketing Strategy Document	Get a comprehensive marketing strategy crafted to meet your unique business objectives. This task captures your company's story, ideal customers, positioning, content plan and strategic marketing goals. Ultimately, the strategy provides a foundation for the engagement and ensures all stakeholders are on the same page.	40
Develop Content Plan Document	Strategize your content initiatives with a plan that outlines topics, formats, and distribution channels. This document ensures that your content resonates with your target audience, establishes authority, and drives engagement.	30
Develop Web Plan Document	Establish a roadmap for your online presence with a detailed plan that covers website design, user experience, and functionality. This document ensures that your website aligns with your brand's goals and offers an optimal experience for visitors.	50
Set Up Website	Create staging and live environments for your company's online presence. Utilize Wordpress CMS and create fresh install with designated themes, plugins, and scripts.	10
Set Up Content	Set up a comprehensive content program according to the established plan. Examples include thought leadership articles, video series, podcasts.	5
Launch Content	Launch a specific content program, by publishing and promoting content that resonates with your target audience.	1
Develop Blog Post w/ Interview + Video	Elevate the traditional blog format by incorporating both written insights from an expert interview and an accompanying video segment, offering readers a multi-dimensional content experience.	12
Develop Blog Post	Write a well-researched and insightful blog post that addresses industry trends or audience pain points, establishing your brand as a thought leader in the field.	8
Develop Newsletter Template (Design & Dev)	Design and develop a customizable newsletter template that aligns with your brand's visual identity, ensuring a consistent and professional look for all your newsletter editions.	5
Set Up MarTech Stack	Set up a minimal tech stack including Marketing Automation, Analytics Dashboards	15
Tech Stack	Tech stack to support reporting, platforms for campaigns.	5
Total		**211**

Task	Description	Stage	Points
Develop ABM Plan (New Accounts) Document	Design a targeted approach to B2B marketing with a plan that identifies key accounts and outlines personalized engagement strategies. The plan identifies key offers and the associated channels for promotion. This document ensures that your ABM initiatives are cohesive, targeted, and effective. Includes the technical architecture to meet the needs across email, LinkedIn, paid channels.	Foundation	35
Develop ABM Plan (Re-engagement Accounts) Document	Design a targeted approach to B2B marketing with a plan that identifies key accounts and outlines personalized engagement strategies. The plan identifies key offers and the associated channels for promotion. This document ensures that your ABM initiatives are cohesive, targeted, and effective. Includes the technical architecture to meet the needs across email, LinkedIn, paid channels.	Foundation	35
Develop Marketing Operations Implementation Plan	Identify key adjustments to Hubspot/Salesforce sync, confirm custom fields and document workflows needed to support reporting requirements.	Foundation	20
Develop Performance Reporting Plan Document	Identify the key data points that we will track for the various campaigns we are running, where this data comes from, and how we can get access to that data to report on. This document ensures that we have a plan for tracking campaign performance across relevant channels. Build requirements for specific dashboards in Hubspot to support reporting requirements.	Foundation	20
Develop SEO / AEO Plan Document	Elevate your online presence with a strategic SEO / AEO plan that outlines keyword research, on-page optimization, and link-building opportunities. During this process, we conduct an audit of your existing traffic, identify priorities for optimization and pinpoint new opportunities for content creation. This document ensures your website ranks higher on search engines, answer engines, and attracts quality traffic to boost your brand's visibility.	Foundation	30
Develop Content Plan Document	Strategize your content initiatives with a plan that outlines topics, formats, and distribution channels. This document ensures that your content resonates with your target audience, establishes authority, and drives engagement. Includes creation of video series and other pillar content to support thought leadership programs.	Foundation	60
Develop Paid Media Plan Document	Optimize your advertising efforts with a plan that details budget allocation, platform selection, and targeting criteria. This document serves as a guide to ensure your paid media campaigns achieve maximum ROI and effectively reach your target audience. Up to 3 channels and $10k in ad spend. Additional channels and/or spend will have a custom points value.	Execution	40
Facilitate Client Meetings	Align on progress and pave the way for future successes. This collaborative session involves reviewing the status of current tasks and strategizing for the month ahead, fostering a cohesive and proactive approach to achieving your business objectives and maintaining a steady trajectory of growth.	Analysis	10
Total			**250**

Task	Description	Stage	Points
Hubspot Email Sequences & Workflows	Develop a set of email sequences and workflows in Hubspot to support reengagement campaigns. Sequences include email templates, workflow design and testing.	Execution	25
Set up content & create graphics package	Launch a specific content program, by publishing and promoting content that resonates with your target audience. Includes development of animations, lower thirds and the visual elements to support each episode's post-production.	Execution	30
Develop campaign package	Develop a set of two one-pagers (either downloadable PDFs or designed webpages) to support key topics or themes relevant to the winback target list or industry list. Optionally, create a detailed blog post based on an interview. In addition, craft two short video "sizzle" pieces to promote in an email or on a landing page. Content package supports up to six emails in a sequence. Craft email copy to fulfill the six emails.	Execution	75
Develop image ad creative package	Create a package of visually compelling image ads designed to capture attention and drive engagement, ensuring your brand stands out in advertising spaces.	Execution	10
Set up ABM	Lay the foundation for targeted ABM campaigns by identifying key accounts, setting up the infrastructure and crafting personalized engagement strategies. Continuously monitor and refine your ABM initiatives, ensuring they remain effective, relevant, and aligned with the evolving needs of your target accounts.	Execution	40
Manage Paid Media	Oversee and optimize your advertising campaigns, making real-time adjustments based on performance data to ensure maximum reach, engagement, and ROI. Starts with 2 channels and minimum of $2k in ad spend.	Execution	20
Manage SEO / AEO	Continuously monitor and refine your SEO strategies, making adjustments based on performance data to ensure sustained organic visibility and traffic growth.	Execution	5
Manage Content	Manage and execute a content program by generating ideas, creating blogs, videos, and podcasts, or other pieces of content. Continuously review performance to refine and improve results.	Execution	10
Tech Stack	Tech stack to support reporting, platforms for campaigns. Includes RB2B, n8n, Factors, SmartLead, HeyReach, Riverside, Databox, etc.	Execution	15
Listbuilding and Enrichment	Develop a list of targeted contacts aligned with the ICPs in the ABM campaign; includes up to 2,500 enriched "new" contacts (email, title validation, and other custom fields)	Execution	25
Facilitate Client Meetings	Align on progress and pave the way for future successes. This collaborative session involves reviewing the status of current tasks and strategizing for the month ahead, fostering a cohesive and proactive approach to achieving your business objectives and maintaining a steady trajectory of growth.	Analysis	10
Total			**265**

Task	Description	Stage	Points
Develop episode for a series (2)	Based on a live episode recording, craft an engaging podcast or video series episode that delves into relevant topics, offering listeners valuable insights and expert opinions, fostering a community of loyal followers. Episode content suite typically includes promo/clip videos, full-length video, audio, and short form written content.	Execution	20
Develop image ad creative package	Create a package of visually compelling image ads designed to capture attention and drive engagement, ensuring your brand stands out in advertising spaces.	Execution	10
Create SEO blog post inspired by transcript (2)	Write an insightful, 1,500–1,800 word blog post based on the provided transcript. The piece should be strategically crafted and fully optimized to achieve a specific SEO objective defined by the organization.	Execution	20
Develop slide deck or presentation	Create a comprehensive slide deck to support your sales team. Includes outline, copy and custom design elements.	Execution	15
Develop campaign package	Develop a set of two one-pagers (either downloadable PDFs or designed webpages) to support key topics or themes relevant to the winback target list or industry list. Optionally, create a detailed blog post based on an interview. In addition, craft two short video "sizzle" pieces to promote in an email or on a landing page. Content package supports up to six emails in a sequence. Craft email copy to fulfill the six emails.	Execution	75
Manage Paid Media	Oversee and optimize your advertising campaigns, making real-time adjustments based on performance data to ensure maximum reach, engagement, and ROI. Starts with 2 channels and minimum of $2k in ad spend.	Execution	20
Manage SEO / AEO	Continuously monitor and refine your SEO strategies, making adjustments based on performance data to ensure sustained organic visibility and traffic growth.	Execution	5
Manage Content	Manage and execute a content program by generating ideas, creating blogs, videos, and podcasts, or other pieces of content. Continuously review performance to refine and improve results.	Execution	10
Manage ABM	Multi-channel engagement tracking across email, LinkedIn, and website touchpoints with AI-powered lead qualification, real-time sales notifications, account-level analytics, and weekly performance reporting.	Execution	15
Facilitate Client Meetings	Align on progress and pave the way for future successes. This collaborative session involves reviewing the status of current tasks and strategizing for the month ahead, fostering a cohesive and proactive approach to achieving your business objectives and maintaining a steady trajectory of growth.	Analysis	10
Tech Stack	Tech stack to support reporting, platforms for campaigns. Includes RB2B, n8n, Factors, SmartLead, HeyReach, Riverside, Databox, etc.	Execution	15
Total			**215**